rela Hospital

Caring for Your Mind and Heart During Pregnancy



Welcome

Congratulations on your pregnancy. This booklet is a simple guide to help you understand your emotional and mental well-being during pregnancy. Taking care of your feelings is just as important as taking care of your body. Many mothers experience worries, mood changes, or stress – you are not alone, and help is available.



Why Emotional Health Matters

Your thoughts, feelings, and relationships can affect:

- Your own health and happiness
- Your baby's growth and development
- Your bonding with your baby

Taking care of your mind helps you enjoy pregnancy and prepares you for motherhood.



Common Feelings During Pregnancy

It is normal to experience a range of emotions. Some common challenges include:

Feeling Sad or Low

- Crying often
- Loss of interest in daily activities
- Feeling tired all the time

Feeling Anxious or Worried

- Worrying too much about the baby or delivery
- Feeling restless or tense
- Trouble sleeping

Stress

- Feeling overwhelmed by work, family, or finances
- Difficulty concentrating

Fear of Childbirth

- Fear of pain or complications
- Fear of losing control

Body Changes and Self-Confidence

- Worry about weight gain or stretch marks
- Feeling less confident about your appearance



Changes in Your Body and How to Cope

Early Pregnancy

- Nausea and vomiting
- Extreme tiredness

Helpful tips:

- Eat small meals often
- Rest when needed
- Drink plenty of fluids



Mid-Pregnancy

- Back pain
- Leg cramps

Helpful tips:

- Maintain good posture
- Gentle stretching
- Wear supportive shoes

Late Pregnancy

- Swelling of feet
- Trouble sleeping

Helpful tips:

- Elevate your legs
- Sleep on your side with pillows

Simple Ways to Care for Your Emotional Health

Take Time to Relax

- Practice slow breathing
- Listen to calming music
- Try prenatal yoga if approved by your doctor

Talk to Someone You Trust

- Share your feelings with your partner
- Talk to a family member or friend
- Attend Antenatal Sessions

Be Kind to Yourself

- Your body is doing amazing work
- It is okay to rest and ask for help

Connect With Your Baby

- Talk or sing to your baby
- Gently rub your belly

When to Ask for Help

Please seek help if:

- Sadness or worry lasts more than 2 weeks
- You feel hopeless or very overwhelmed
- You think about harming yourself

This is not your fault. Help works best when started early.

Support From Partners and Family

Partners and family can help by:

- Listening without judging
- Helping with daily chores
- Attending clinic visits with you

Remember

- Many women experience emotional changes in pregnancy
- Support is available
- Taking care of your mind is taking care of your baby

You are strong, and you are not alone.

Where to Get Help

- Talk to your midwife or doctor
- Reach out to our psychologist for counselling and therapy
- Emergency support if you feel unsafe

Always reach out – support is part of good motherhood.







rela Hospital

24x7 EMERGENCY CARE
044 6666 7788

+91 44 6666 7777
+91 44 7111 1117

info@relainstitute.com

www.relainstitute.com

RELA HOSPITAL
7, CLC Works Road,
Chromepet, Chennai 600044